[INCH - POUND]

A-A-1658B
May 24, 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1658A
June 11, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, PACKING LIST (SELF ADHESIVE, PLASTIC)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification PPP-E-540, Classes I, II, III, and IV, Style 4.

This description covers water-resistant, self adhesive, plastic envelopes, suitable for the protection of packing lists and shipping documents.

Classification. Envelopes shall be of the following styles and sizes as specified (see Section 6):

Style A - Legend: PACKING LIST ENCLOSED
Style B - Legend: MATERIAL RELEASE/RECEIPT DOCUMENTS
Style C - Legend: MATERIAL RELEASE/RECEIPT DOCUMENTS ENCLOSED
Style D - Legend: NOTICE, THIS ENVELOPE CONTAINS IMPORTANT PAPERS. DO NOT DESTROY.
Style E - Without a legend

Size 1 - 3 x 4-3/4 inches
Size 2 - 3-11/16 x 7-1/2 inches
Size 3 - 4-3/4 x 7 inches
Size 4 - 5 x 8-1/2 inches
Size 5 - 8 x 9-1/2 inches

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A. Construction. Envelopes furnished under this description shall be fabricated from a plastic film which meets the requirements of Table I for Impact Resistance and Water Vapor Transmission Rate. The back of each envelope shall have not less than 75 percent of its area covered with a pressure sensitive adhesive. The adhesive shall be protected by a liner which is easily removeable without causing the adhesive to separate from the back of the envelope. The adhesive coated plastic film shall meet the requirements of Table I for Peel Adhesion. The envelopes shall be shall be constructed in such a manner as to protect the contents from water

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited

FSC 8105

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penetration during the Water Resistance Test. Unless otherwise specified, the front of the envelope shall be bright orange or bright pink in color. Class 1 envelopes shall have the legend printed on the front in black letters, centered to within ± 1/2 inch. Each letter shall be not less than 1/2 inch high. The legend shall be clearly legible at the conclusion of the Water Resistance Test. The Heat-Sealed Seam Test shall not cause seam separation of more than 1/16 inch.

TABLE I

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Impact Resistance of Uncoated Film	Impact Failure Weight shall be not less than 100 g	ASTM D 1709 Method A
Water Vapor Transmission Rate Uncoated Film	Not more than 10 grams per square meter per day	ASTM F 372 (determined at 37.8°C and 90 percent relative humidity)
Peel Adhesion of Adhesive Coated Film	Not less than 25 ounces per inch of width	ASTM D 3330 Method A (Cut the test specimens from the adhesive coated film instead of from rolls of tape.)

B. Dimensions. Dimensions of the envelopes shall be inside dimensions, exclusive of flaps or seals. The opening shall be along the shorter side. Dimensions shall be as specified, with a tolerance of ± 1/8 inch.

C. Workmanship. Envelopes shall be uniformly constructed and free from pinholes, tears, cuts, sharp creases, or wrinkles. The legend shall be clearly legible and not smudged or otherwise marred.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

A. Testing of components for the requirements of Table I. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A lot shall consist of all plastic film manufactured by the same process,

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from the same components, at the same time. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1000 square yards of film. The sample unit shall be 6 square feet of uncoated film or 1 square foot of adhesive coated film, as applicable. The Inspection Level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective, for each test.

B. Examination of the end item for construction, dimensions and workmanship. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A lot shall consist of all envelopes of the same size manufactured by the same process, from the same components, at the same time. The lot size shall be expressed in units of envelopes. The sample unit shall be 1 envelope. The Inspection Level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

C. Testing of the end item for Water Resistance and Heat-Sealed Seams. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A lot shall consist of all envelopes of the same size manufactured by the same process, from the same components, at same time. The lot size shall be expressed in units of envelopes. The sample unit shall be 4 envelopes. The Inspection Level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective, for each test.

1) Water Resistance Test. One envelope from each sample unit shall be tested for water resistance in accordance with ASTM D 951. A simulated packing list consisting of 1 sheet of 9 pound (17 X 22 - 500) manifold paper folded in quarters shall be inserted into the envelope. The unfolded area of the sheet shall be not less than 2 times the area obtained by multiplying the length times the width of the packing list envelope. The manifold paper may be cut to size or sheets may taped together when necessary to make a simulated packing list of the proper size. The envelope shall be carefully sealed and the liner removed; then the envelope shall be securely fastened to a piece of wood using only the pressure sensitive adhesive on the back of the envelope. The piece of wood, with the envelope attached, shall be placed in a vertical position ($90 \pm 10^{\circ}$) in the test room or chamber and exposed to a medium intensity ($2 \pm 1/2$ inches per hour) spray of water at $73.4 \pm 3.6^{\circ}F$ for not less than 24 hours. Immediately after exposure to the water spray, the packing list envelope shall be examined. The envelope shall remain securely attached to the piece of wood. Drops of water shall not be present inside the envelope. The simulated packing list shall remain dry enough so that it can be completely unfolded without tearing.

2) Heat-Sealed Seam Test. Three envelopes from each sample unit shall be tested for seam strength in accordance with Method 2024 of FED-STD-101 except that 1 specimen from each envelope shall be

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tested and the test weight shall be 650 ± 10 g. The 3 specimens shall be selected so that the seam opposite the open end of the envelope is tested once and the seam adjacent to the open end is tested twice.

0. Examination of packaging, packing and marking. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A lot shall consist of all material presented for inspection at the same time. The lot size for packaging, packing, and marking shall be expressed in units of issue of envelopes. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container. The Inspection Level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective..

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

4. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING: Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A. Public Law

Public Law 94-580 - Resource Conservation and Recovery Act,
(Part of U. S. Code, Title 42)

Available from:

Congressional Sales Office
U. S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402

B. Federal Standard

FED-STD-101 - Test Procedures for Packaging Materials

Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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Federal Government Activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.

C. Military Standard

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-105 is available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue,
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

D. Other Publications:

ASTM D 951 - Standard Test Method for Water Resistance of Shipping Containers by the Spray Method
ASTM D 1709 - Standard Test Methods for Impact Resistance of Polyethylene Film By the Free Falling Dart Method
ASTM D 3330 - Standard Test Methods for Peel Adhesion of Pressure Sensitive Tape at 180° Angle
ASTM F 372 - Standard Test Method for Water Vapor Transmission Rate of Flexible Barrier Materials Using an Infrared Detection Technique

ASTM Test Methods are available from:

American Society for Testing and Materials
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103.

6. NOTES:

A. Purchasers shall specify:

1) Style and size required;
2) Packaging, packing, and marking required.

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A-A-1658

6. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (for cataloging use only)

AA1658 - A 1

This example describes a 3 x 4-3/4 inch packing list envelope in accordance with A-A-1658 which has the legend: PACKING LIST ENCLOSED.

Size 1 - 3 x 4-3/4 inches
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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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